LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH JUNIOR (K–2) ADVANCED: GAME BUILDERS

Lesson 1: Tap to Start 👆

Module 1 | 30 minutes | Events (tap to start) | KG–Grade 2 · ages 6–7

Objective: Start a script by tapping a character, and choose between the green flag and tap starts.

Success criteria

- I can use start on tap.
- I know when to use flag or tap.
- I can give a character two scripts.

Key vocabulary

- **tap**: Touch the screen quickly.
- **start on tap**: Runs a script when the character is tapped.
- **interact**: The player does something and the game answers.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (30 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Doorbell game (5 min): children only act when tapped.
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	A character that reacts: learners follow the steps.
5 min	**Perform**	Tickle the cat, Tap to fly, Green flag or start on tap?
3 min	**Probe**	Which start?, Tap and act
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: Show me the start-on-tap block.

Unplugged warm-up

Doorbell game (5 min): children only act when tapped.

Teaching the idea

Event-driven interaction: “start on tap” (touch event) triggers a sprite’s script, distinct from the global green-flag event. Characters can hold several scripts with different triggers.

Analogy: A doorbell: it only rings when someone presses it.

Live demo: Show a flag script and a tap script on one character; trigger each.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What starts this script?	A tap.
Can a character have two scripts?	Yes.
Which start is best for a button?	Tap.

Differentiation

Support
Pre-build the action; children add the tap start.

Stretch
Two characters with different tap reactions.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
The flag starts tap scripts	Tap scripts start only when tapped.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

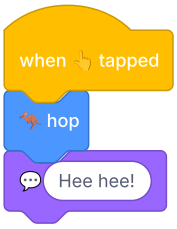
Exit ticket
Show me the start-on-tap block.

Homework
Find things at home that start when you press them (lift button, toaster).

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Tickle the cat (perform · block code)

One solution:



2. Tap to fly (perform · block code)

One solution:



3. Green flag or start on tap? (perform · categorize)

🏁 **Green flag:** Start the whole game, Play music at the start
👆 **Start on tap:** Make one character jump when touched, A button you press to shoot

4. Which start? (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: 👆 Start on tap

5. Tap and act (probe · speaking)

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** tap = Touch the screen quickly. · start on tap = Runs a script when the character is tapped. · interact = The player does something and the game answers.
2. **Green flag or start on tap?:** 🏁 Green flag: Start the whole game, Play music at the start · 👆 Start on tap: Make one character jump when touched, A button you press to shoot
3. **Which start?:** A. 👆 Start on tap — Tap starts a script when you touch the character.
4. **Flag or tap?:** 🏁, 👆, 🏁

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